

Build Steps — Update

Part 1 of 3 — What "Add a Tool" actually means today. Use this alongside any Build-Along deck's Step 6; it replaces outdated "HTTP trigger" wording with the current Copilot Studio experience.

1 What Changed Since the Original Decks

The original Build-Along decks describe Step 6 as a "Power Automate cloud flow (HTTP trigger)." That trigger type no longer applies — flows attached to an agent as a tool now require a specific shape:

Required for any flow used as a tool:

- Trigger: **When an agent calls the flow**
- Response: **Respond to the agent** (Asynchronous response = **Off**)
- Must respond within the **100-second** action limit
- Must be **Published** before it's selectable as a tool

No separate Power Automate license is needed — flows built this way ("agent flows") are billed through Copilot Studio capacity, not Power Automate premium entitlements.

2 The 5 Tool Types in "Add a Tool"

Connectors

A single Power Platform connector action (SharePoint, Dataverse, Outlook, ServiceNow...) added directly — no flow required for a one-step action.

Agent flows

Multi-step automation you build yourself — the right choice whenever a tool needs more than one action (write a record, then notify someone).

MCP servers

Model Context Protocol servers — for connecting a broader external tool ecosystem beyond native connectors.

REST APIs

Any custom REST endpoint your agent can reach, described with an OpenAPI-style schema.

Prompts and **Skills** are related but distinct: a Prompt is a reusable AI instruction added as a tool; a Skill defines a structured behavior pattern. Neither replaces the four tool types above — they sit alongside them in the same panel.

Building the Flow

Part 2 of 3 — Two ways to build an agent flow, and how to attach it to your agent once it's published.

3 Option A — Natural Language (fastest)

1. Go to **Flows** in the left nav.
2. In the Copilot chat panel, describe the flow in plain language — name the trigger, the connectors, the actions, and any specific parameters (list names, channel names) up front.
3. Review the generated plan. Refine conversationally: *"Post an adaptive card instead of a plain message,"* or *"Add a field for whether it's paid or unpaid."*
4. Confirm — Copilot builds the full flow: trigger, actions, connections, and the response node.
5. It opens in the designer for review. **This is a one-way door** — once you edit in the designer, the chat panel can no longer modify the flow.
6. Test, then **Publish**.

4 Option B — Designer (full control)

1. **Flows** → **New flow** → **Agent flow**. The starter template already includes the required trigger and response nodes.
2. Add input parameters to the trigger for every value the agent needs to pass in.
3. Add your actions between trigger and response (e.g. SharePoint *Create item*, Teams notification, Office 365 Users *Get manager (V2)*).
4. Add output parameters to **Respond to the agent** so the agent gets something back to confirm or reference.
5. **Publish**.

Use Option A to get a working first draft in under a minute; drop into Option B (the same designer it opens into) to fix anything the generator guessed wrong — most commonly a connector choice or a field mapping.

5 Attach the Flow to the Agent

1. **Tools** → **Add a tool** → filter by **Flow**. Only published flows with the correct trigger/response pair are listed here — if yours is missing, that's the first thing to check.
2. Select it → **Add and configure**.
3. Set **Name** and a specific **Description** — the orchestrator selects tools by reading this text, so vague descriptions mean the agent picks the wrong tool or none at all.
4. Under **Inputs**, choose how each value gets filled: from the conversation, a fixed value, or a system value like the signed-in user.
5. Under **Completion**, choose what the agent does with the result.
6. **Save**. You can also attach a flow at the **topic** level instead of the agent level, if it should only ever be reachable from one specific conversation flow.

Adaptive Cards & Quick Reference

Part 3 of 3 — Posting a Teams adaptive card instead of a plain message, and a lookup table mapping old deck wording to current terms.

6 Post a Teams Adaptive Card

1. Add the Teams action **Post your own adaptive card as the Flow bot to a user** (or **...to a channel** for team notifications).
2. Set **Recipient** — e.g. the output of an **Office 365 Users — Get manager (V2)** action upstream.
3. Build the card JSON at **adaptivecards.io/designer**: add TextBlocks for each field you want shown, then copy the JSON from the Payload Editor tab.
4. Paste the JSON into the action's **Adaptive Card** field.
5. Replace each static placeholder value by clicking into that spot in the JSON and inserting the matching field from **Dynamic content** — this drops in a live expression token in place of the placeholder text.
6. **Test** in the designer to confirm the card renders correctly before publishing.

Workshop tip — pre-build one working card JSON with the tokens already correctly placed, and let every team swap in their own field names. Designing a card from scratch in the Adaptive Cards Designer costs 10+ minutes per team.

7 Old Wording → Current Wording

ORIGINAL BUILD-ALONG DECK SAID	USE THIS INSTEAD
"Power Automate cloud flow (HTTP trigger)"	Agent flow — "When an agent calls the flow" trigger + "Respond to the agent"
"Add a tool → choose a connector, flow, custom HTTP, or MCP server"	Add a tool → Connectors / Agent flows / MCP servers / REST APIs (Prompts and Skills sit alongside, not under Tools)
Build the flow in make.powerautomate.com, then add it to a Solution	Build directly in Copilot Studio's Flows page — no separate portal, no manual Solution step
"Post message in a chat or channel" (plain text)	"Post your own adaptive card as the Flow bot to a user/channel" when a structured card is wanted
Author the flow node-by-node from scratch	Describe it in plain language first (natural-language builder), then fine-tune in the designer